

First Volo Morphology

Grades 4-5 Morphology Progress Monitoring Probe

Educator Guide

Purpose

A brief, informal progress-monitoring measure of students' knowledge of Greek and Latin word parts and their ability to use morphology to analyze and infer the meanings of unfamiliar words. Forms A and B are parallel forms that may be alternated across administrations to monitor change over time. This is not a standardized assessment or an official Common Core assessment.

Administration

- Directions, target words, sentences, and answer choices may be read aloud.
- Do not define a target word, identify its parts, or tell the student what a morpheme means during scored items.
- Repeat directions if needed without teaching the answer.
- **Record the student and educator information appropriate for your setting and follow local school or district privacy procedures.**
- **Teach the target morphemes during instruction, but for a clearer measure of transfer avoid directly teaching the exact probe words between administrations when possible.**

Transfer Word Note

The transfer items use whole words that should remain unfamiliar when possible. Avoid directly teaching the exact probe words before the next administration; teaching the same morphemes in other words is encouraged.

CCSS Skills Sampled

Standard	Skill sampled
RF.4.3a / RF.5.3a	Use morphology, together with other word-analysis knowledge, to read unfamiliar multisyllabic words.
L.4.4a / L.5.4a	Use context as a clue to the meaning of an unknown word or phrase.
L.4.4b / L.5.4b	Use common, grade-appropriate Greek and Latin affixes and roots as clues to word meaning.

Primary construct: L.4.4b/L.5.4b morphological meaning inference. Structural-analysis items support RF.4.3a/RF.5.3a, but because the examiner may read target words aloud, this probe should not be interpreted as an independent decoding measure. Standards source: Common Core State Standards Initiative, ELA/Literacy Standards.

Grades 4-5 Morphology Probe

Form A

Student:

Educator:

Grade:

Date:

Form: A

Directions: Use what you know about word parts. If you are not sure, choose the answer that makes the most sense.

Part 1 - Know the Word Parts

1. What does bio usually mean?
 - A. life
 - B. sound
 - C. time
2. What does graph usually mean?
 - A. carry
 - B. write or record
 - C. heat
3. What does tele usually mean?
 - A. far or distant
 - B. small
 - C. earth
4. What does -able / -ible usually mean?
 - A. without
 - B. can be or able to be
 - C. person who

Part 2 - Break It Apart

5. Break predict into its meaningful parts.

6. Break readable into its meaningful parts.

Part 3 - Figure Out New Words

7. What does microhabitat probably mean?
 - A. a very small habitat
 - B. a habitat far away
 - C. a habitat without life
8. What does teleconference probably mean?
 - A. a meeting held over a distance
 - B. a meeting about writing
 - C. a meeting before school
9. What does biographer probably mean?
 - A. a person who writes about someone's life
 - B. a person who measures distance
 - C. a person who studies heat

Grades 4-5 Morphology Probe

Form A - continued

Student:	Educator:	Grade:
Date:	Form: A	

Part 4 - Use Word Parts and Context

10. Read or listen:

Before the final vote, the class will preselect three choices from the long list.

- What does preselect probably mean?
- A. choose ahead of time
 - B. choose again
 - C. choose from far away

Part 5 - Build a Word

11. Combine bio + graph + -y. What word do you make?

What does the word mean?

Part 6 - Explain Your Thinking

12. The carpenter decided to premeasure the boards before cutting them. What does premeasure probably mean?

How did a word part help you figure it out?

Educator Score

Morpheme knowledge /4	Structural analysis /2	Independent transfer /3	Total /12
Morphology + context /1	Word construction /1	Reasoning /1	

Grades 4-5 Morphology Probe

Form B

Student:

Educator:

Grade:

Date:

Form: B

Directions: Use what you know about word parts. If you are not sure, choose the answer that makes the most sense.

Part 1 - Know the Word Parts

1. What does geo usually mean?
 - A. earth
 - B. write
 - C. small
2. What does port usually mean?
 - A. look
 - B. carry
 - C. life
3. What does micro usually mean?
 - A. before
 - B. small
 - C. far
4. What does -ist usually mean?
 - A. person who does or studies
 - B. can be
 - C. without

Part 2 - Break It Apart

5. Break project into its meaningful parts.

6. Break washable into its meaningful parts.

Part 3 - Figure Out New Words

7. What does microcomputer probably mean?
 - A. a small computer
 - B. a computer used far away
 - C. a computer that measures heat
8. What does telework probably mean?
 - A. work done from a distance
 - B. work done before lunch
 - C. work about the earth
9. What does transportable probably mean?
 - A. able to be carried or moved
 - B. unable to be moved
 - C. a person who studies transportation

Grades 4-5 Morphology Probe

Form B - continued

Student:	Educator:	Grade:
Date:	Form: B	

Part 4 - Use Word Parts and Context

10. Read or listen:

The shaded canyon has a cooler microclimate than the hot land around it.

- What does microclimate probably mean?
- A. the climate of a small area
 - B. the climate of the whole planet
 - C. a climate from long ago

Part 5 - Build a Word

11. Combine geo + graph + -y. What word do you make?

What does the word mean?

Part 6 - Explain Your Thinking

12. The organizers prearranged the chairs before the families arrived. What does prearranged probably mean?

How did a word part help you figure it out?

Educator Score

Morpheme knowledge /4	Structural analysis /2	Independent transfer /3	Total /12
Morphology + context /1	Word construction /1	Reasoning /1	

Educator Scoring & Standards Map

Grades 4-5 Forms A and B

Give 1 point per item. For Item 11, require both the correctly formed word and an essentially correct meaning. For Item 12, require both an essentially correct whole-word interpretation and a reasonable explanation connecting the word part to meaning.

#	Skill	Form A / Form B answer	CCSS	Alignment
1	Greek/Latin combining-form meaning	bio = life / geo = earth	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct
2	Greek/Latin root meaning	graph = write/record / port = carry	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct
3	Greek combining-form meaning	tele = far / micro = small	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct
4	Derivational suffix meaning	-able/-ible = can be / -ist = person who does or studies	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct
5	Analyze prefix + bound root	pre + dict / pro + ject	RF.4.3a; RF.5.3a; L.4/5.4b	Supporting word-analysis measure
6	Analyze base + suffix	read + able / wash + able	RF.4.3a; RF.5.3a; L.4/5.4b	Supporting word-analysis measure
7	Independent morphology transfer	very small habitat / small computer	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct
8	Independent morphology transfer	meeting over distance / work from distance	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct
9	Multi-part morphology transfer	person who writes about a life / able to be carried or moved	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct
10	Morphology + context	choose ahead of time / climate of a small area	L.4.4a-b; L.5.4a-b	Direct/combined strategy
11	Construct + interpret a word	biography / geography	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Supporting constructed response
12	Infer + explain morphology	measure before / arrange before	L.4.4b; L.5.4b	Direct skill + explanation

Item 11 Meaning Criteria

Accept conceptually accurate meanings

Form A biography: writing or a written account about a person's life. Form B geography: the study or description of Earth, places, and features. Do not require students to reproduce a dictionary definition.

Optional Mediated Probe - Do Not Add to /12 Score

After the independent response is recorded

If a student misses Items 7-10 or 12, the educator may then provide the relevant morpheme meaning(s) and ask again. Record only whether the student becomes correct after the cue. This can help distinguish morpheme-meaning knowledge from the ability to apply a supplied morphological clue.

Progress Monitoring Record

Grades 4-5 First Volo Morphology

Use one record per student. Record and store student information according to your school or district procedures.

Student: _____	Educator: _____
Grade: _____	Date range: _____
Administration 1 Form: _____	Administration 2 Form: _____
Number of First Volo sessions: _____	Approx. total minutes: _____
Word-part study set(s): _____	Activities used: _____

Progress Monitoring Scores

Measure	Initial	Follow-Up	Change	Notes
Morpheme knowledge /4				
Structural analysis /2				
Independent transfer /3				
Morphology + context /1				
Word construction /1				
Explicit reasoning /1				
Total /12				

Engagement & Independence

Rating	1	2	3	4
Engagement	Frequently disengaged	Repeated prompting	Generally engaged	Highly engaged
Independence	Substantial support	Frequent support	Occasional support	Independent

Would the student choose to use it again? Yes / Maybe / No

Would you use this resource again with students? Yes / Maybe / No

Qualitative Observation

Record one example of something the student said or did that showed how they were thinking about a word.
